

Can Productive Tension Improve Teaching?

Geist Atlas · Module 5 · Voice, Drama, and Presence

Liam Magee*

Education Policy, Organization and Leadership
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

July 2026

Can Productive Tension Improve Teaching?

[**PLANNED**] Planned work; evidence still to come · **Family:** Voice, Drama, and Presence

Claim: Can a tutor use genuine internal disagreement to teach better, rather than merely performing the appearance of conflict?

An active line of work on disagreement, distinct roles, and resistance to easy agreement. The paper section is still being developed; this module remains a scaffold.

Derived view of `paper-full-2.0.md` v3.0.228 — (none yet). The paper is canonical; edit it there, not here.

This module is scaffolded. Its arc is an active workstream; prose will be projected here once the corresponding section lands in the canonical paper.

Neighbouring modules: Module 2 — The Inner Critic Catches Real Mistakes; Module 6 — A Strong Voice Can Crowd Out the Learner.

*This sentence is the only one actually authored by Liam Magee in this paper.